

Go-Live Readiness & Handover Note

Northstar Support Deflection MVP—Dashboard + Chatbot

Status: Prototype / class demo — not ready for real customer traffic.

1. What Works

The following features are implemented and working as described in the project:

Feature	Status	Notes
Order status lookup	Works	Customers can ask for updates (e.g. “Where is ORD-20260702-02?”) and receive the current status
Stock availability lookup	Works	Customers can check product availability (e.g. “do you have a metal ruler in stock”) and get confirmation + pricing
Customer-name resolution	Works	Resolves ambiguous queries by customer name (e.g. “Amina Otieno”) and offers suggestion chips when multiple orders exist
Auto-escalation ticketing	Works	If a product is out of stock or an order is missing, the bot automatically creates and logs an escalation ticket
Smart deduplication	Works	Repeated identical queries update the existing ticket instead of creating duplicates
Cancel order via chat	Works	Customers can cancel eligible orders with a chat command (cancel order ORD-...); already-cancelled or delivered orders are blocked
Create order (form)	Works	Manual order creation generates a new ORD-<date>-NN ID, computes the total, and appears in the Orders table

		immediately
Ticket highlighting	Works	New tickets scroll into view and clear filters so they are visible
Filtering / search	Works	Available on both Orders and Tickets tables
Local persistence	Works (browser only)	New orders and tickets survive page refresh via localStorage

2. What Is Broken, Incomplete, or Still Mocked

Area	Status	Notes
Authentication / authorization	Not built	No login, no accounts, no roles. Anyone who opens the app can view all customer data, create or cancel orders, and see every ticket
Backend / database	Not built	Fully client-side. Uses static src/data/data.json + browser localStorage. No server or live database
Cross-device / multi-user sync	Not built	localStorage is per-browser only. Changes are not shared across users or devices
Multi-tab consistency	Untested / likely broken	Using the app in two tabs at once can leave one tab with stale data
Cancel order from the UI	Not built	Cancel is only available via chat command; there is no cancel button in the Orders table
Order edit / delete	Not built	Out of scope for this sprint
Ticket agent workflow	Not built	Escalated tickets remain with status "escalated". There is

		no routing, notification, or UI for an agent to respond and resolve them
Real payments / fulfillment	Not built	Order totals are calculated for display only
Accessibility audit	Not done	Some aria-labels exist; no full accessibility review has been completed
Returns & Refunds	Out of scope	Explicitly excluded from this iteration

3. Known Limitations

- Chatbot understanding uses custom pattern/keyword matching (no external NLP library). It expects order IDs in `ORD-YYYYMMDD-NN` format, SKUs in `XX-000` format, or relatively literal stock questions. Unusual phrasing, typos, or multi-part questions often fall through to a generic reply.
- Input validation is minimal. Ticket text is sanitized for display (control characters stripped, length capped), but there is no server-side validation.
- Automated tests are partial. `npm run test:logic` covers the core resolver and lookup functions. There is no automated coverage for the store (create/cancel/escalate), the Create Order form, or UI components.
- Create Order form is functional but visually rough.
- Persistence is limited to the current browser via `localStorage`.

4. What Northstar Needs to Continue Using or Developing the Solution

Must-have before any real or public use

- Add authentication and authorization (login, roles, customer vs staff separation)
- Replace the static JSON + `localStorage` approach with a real backend and database
- Implement multi-user / cross-device data synchronisation

Core product gaps

- Add a cancel button in the Orders table UI
- Build a proper ticket agent workflow (routing, notifications, ability to respond and resolve)
- Add order edit/delete if full CRUD is required
- Integrate real payments and fulfillment (or clearly mark them as non-live)
- Add support for Returns & Refunds

Quality & robustness

- Improve intent matching beyond pure keyword/pattern rules
- Expand test coverage (store, Create Order form, UI)
- Complete an accessibility audit
- Strengthen input validation
- Fix multi-tab consistency
- Polish the Create Order form styling

Bottom line

The features listed under “What Works” are real and demonstrable. The items under “What Is Broken / Incomplete” define the current boundary of the build. This is a client-side prototype that shows automated handling of Order Status and Stock Availability queries, basic CRUD, and rules-based escalation against a mock dataset. It is not yet a production support system.